

Seven moves. That is the method.

You are not learning to code. You are learning to specify, check and correct.

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- 1 **Ask for clarifying questions before you ask for the thing.**
“Before you build anything, give me a list of questions.” Then read the answers.
- 2 **Screenshot it when you cannot find the words.**
Draw on it, point at what is wrong. A photographed biro sketch works perfectly well.
- 3 **Answer in plain English.**
Not a specification. “*The number line is squashed and buried*” is a good instruction.
- 4 **Do not be the sole expert.**
Over-specifying caps it at your own ceiling. Say what students need to understand.
- 5 **Be your dumbest self when you are stuck.**
“Walk me through it like I have never seen a computer.” A technique, not a confession.
- 6 **Use one AI to write the prompt for another one.**
Describe it to the first, ask for the ideal prompt, paste that into the second.
- 7 **Keep a CLAUDE.md so the next chat knows what the last one did.**
A plain notes file: how it works, the house rules, what changed last time.

THE PROMPT — FOUR PARTS

[Context] Read my project brief, then read [THE FILE].

[The change] Change it from [THIS] to [THAT].

[The test] It works when I can [ONE SENTENCE].

[The limits] One self-contained file, no libraries, keep the design tokens, don't add anything I didn't ask for. Give me back the whole file.

TWO RULES THAT PREVENT MOST OF THE PAIN

If you cannot describe it in two sentences, you cannot ask for it yet.
Go and write the two sentences.

If you cannot tell whether the output is right, do not build it yet.
Build the thing where you would spot an error.

Report a bug with the failing case:
“Question 7 was $8 \div 3$, which isn't whole.” Not “fix the divisions”.

BEFORE IT GOES NEAR A CLASS — GENERATE TWENTY AND MARK THEM BY HAND

- **Fractions** that do not simplify, or simplify wrongly.
- **Minus signs** rendered as hyphens on a projector.
- **Rounding** that gives 0.30000000000000004.
- **“Random”** that never gives the case you built it for.
- **Divisors** that can be zero; answers that are not whole.
- **Answer keys** that do not match the printed sheet.
- **$1/3 = 0.3333$** — with an equals sign, to thirty children.
- **Marking rules** that fire on the correct answer.

Everything from the session: millsmathstools.au/vibe-code
One starter file, or the whole pack. No account, nothing collected.

Pedagogy first.
Prompts and code second.
The maths thinking is still yours.